

Smart Kitchen™

Family Guide

Your Household Guide to AI-Powered Meal Planning • Version 10.0 • May 2026
smart-kitchen-opal.vercel.app

For Andrew & Leslie's Family • Liz & Kyle's Family

HOW THIS APP STARTED

Sue asked 'What's for dinner?' and I would get irritated. Not at Sue — never at Sue. Just at the question itself. One more decision at the end of a day that already had too many.

So I sat down to learn AI for my insurance practice and accidentally built a meal planning app.

You two families were the first people I trusted with this. Your feedback shapes everything built next.

— Rick

WHAT SMART KITCHEN DOES

7-Day Meal Plan	One tap builds a full week of dinners around your inventory, family size, dietary needs, and what you've liked before.
 Occasion Planner — NEW	Plan a special event meal — Birthday Dinner, Dinner Party, Date Night, Backyard BBQ, Kids Party. AI generates one perfect meal with shopping list and make-ahead tips, then drops it into your calendar.
 SMS Shopping List — NEW	Tap 'Text to...' on the Shopping tab and the full list goes straight to your phone as a text message. Add a phone number in Settings once and it works every week.
 Birthday Planning — NEW	Add Date of Birth to each family profile. A 🎂 banner appears on the meal plan the week of a birthday. Tap it to plan a birthday dinner in two taps.
Adaptive Learning	The AI learns what your family cooks, loves, and skips. After a few weeks it starts predicting what you want before you ask.
Wild Harvest	Andrew's venison, salmon, and panfish logged as inventory. The AI builds meals around what he brings home.
Home Harvest	Garden produce, backyard eggs, preserved goods — all tracked with shelf life and surfaced before anything spoils.
Leftover Scanner	Photograph a leftover container. App identifies the dish, estimates servings, sets a use-by date.
Busy Night Flag	Mark a hectic evening — the app swaps in a quick 20-minute meal.
Shopping List Email	Set up a shopping partner in Settings — one tap emails the full categorized list.
Star Ratings	Rate any meal 1-5 stars. 1 star bans it. 5 stars makes it a Keeper on a 4-week rotation.
Support Chat	Built-in AI support — tap the bubble. Knows your family profile and inventory.

NEW THIS WEEK — MAY 31, 2026

Occasion Planner

Planning a dinner party? Anniversary dinner? Birthday? Backyard BBQ? The Occasion Planner handles all of it.

How to use it:

- Tap  Plan Occasion in the top bar — or the Occasion button on any meal day card
- Name the occasion ("Anniversary", "Backyard BBQ", "Kylie's birthday dinner")

- Pick your event type: Quick, Casual, Formal, Dinner Party, or Pop Up
- Choose your audience: Family, Kids Party, Date Night, Mixed Crowd, or Adults Party (21+)
- Set head count, mode (Use What I Have vs. Surprise Me), and budget if shopping
- Tap Plan Occasion — AI generates one perfect meal with make-ahead tips and a shopping list
- Tap When is this? Pick Date — enter the date and tap Schedule It
- If the date is this week — that day's meal plan updates automatically with your occasion meal
- If the date is future — opens Google Calendar with the meal pre-filled as an event

Date Night automatically sets head count to 2 and suggests wine pairings. Adults Party (21+) plans shareable crowd-pleasers for BBQs and game days.

SMS Shopping List

Your shopping list goes to any phone as a text message — no email app needed.

Setup (one time):

- Go to Settings → Shopping Partner section
- Enter the phone number you want to text (yours or your spouse's)

Every week:

- Go to the Shopping tab
- Tap the green Text to... button
- List arrives as a text — grouped by category, ready to use in the store

NOTE: On mobile the list opens in your Messages app pre-filled and ready to send. On desktop a setup guide walks you through background SMS via Twilio (takes 5 minutes, optional).

Birthday Planning

Add a Date of Birth to any family member profile and Smart Kitchen handles the rest.

- Go to Family → tap a profile → scroll to Date of Birth
- Enter the birthday — the age displays immediately
- The week of their birthday a 🎂 banner appears on your meal plan
- Tap the banner to open Occasion Planner pre-set to a birthday dinner — two taps to a complete plan

KYLE'S DIABETIC PROFILE — HOW IT WORKS

AUTOMATIC COMPLIANCE Kyle's diabetic-friendly profile means the AI uses brown rice instead of white rice, whole wheat pasta instead of regular, lower glycemic ingredients throughout, and reduced sodium — on every meal, every plan, every occasion. Set once. Enforced everywhere — including occasion meals and birthday dinners.

QUICK REFERENCE

I want to...	Do this...
Plan a birthday dinner	Tap 🎂 banner on meal plan week, or tap 🎉 Plan Occasion → name the occasion → Formal → Family
Text the shopping list	Settings → Shopping Partner → add phone number. Then Shopping tab → green Text to... button
Plan a dinner party	🎉 Plan Occasion → Dinner Party → set head count and budget → Plan Occasion → Schedule It
Add a birthday	Family → profile → Date of Birth field
Weigh a portion (Medical+)	Tap ⚖️ Scale → Connect Scale → place food → type name → Estimate Nutrition

I want to...	Do this...
Ban a meal	1-star it, or tap Change Meal twice on the same meal
Un-ban a meal	Saved tab → Rejected Meals → Restore
Print freezer labels	Inventory tab → Print Labels
Scan leftovers	Leftovers tab → Scan Leftover → photograph container
Get support	Tap the chat bubble at bottom-right